

40.2 SHORT QUESTIONS WITH AUXILIARY VERBS

If a statement contains an auxiliary verb, including modal verbs, that auxiliary verb is repeated in the short question.

I have just come back from Hawaii.



Have you?

Here, "have" is an auxiliary verb forming the present perfect.

FURTHER EXAMPLES

I couldn't wait to come to work today.



Couldn't you?

I've been working since 7am.



Have you?

The train should be here by now.



Should it?

I can't find my car keys.



Can't you?

40.3 SHORT QUESTIONS IN US ENGLISH

In US English, short questions are sometimes not inverted.

Roger is starting a new job tomorrow.



He is?

The subject and verb are not inverted, but this is said with a rising intonation.

My team didn't win the game last night.



They didn't?